

Cold Outreach Compliance Checklist

Turn raw email extraction into a list you can use responsibly — GDPR & CAN-SPAM aware.

The safest email list is not the biggest one. It is the one with a clear source, a clear purpose, and a clear reason to contact each person. Work through this before you send a single message.

STEP 1

Confirm the source context

- ☐ Confirm the page is public and the contact is business-relevant.
- ☐ Check the page does not restrict reuse; record why the data is public.

STEP 2

Define your lawful purpose

- ☐ Write a specific, legitimate reason before the first message (GDPR Art. 6).
- ☐ “We might use this later” is not a lawful basis — be concrete.

STEP 3

Filter before you contact

- ☐ Remove irrelevant roles, duplicates, malformed and outdated records.
- ☐ Never turn raw extraction into automatic outreach — protect deliverability.

STEP 4

Make every message identifiable

- ☐ State who you are, why you’re reaching out, and use a truthful subject line.
- ☐ Include a working opt-out and accurate sender details (CAN-SPAM).

STEP 5

Keep an audit trail

- ☐ Log source URL, extraction date, purpose, and opt-out requests.
- ☐ Be able to answer “why was I added?” for any contact.

STEP 6

Review retention regularly

- ☐ Set a review cadence; delete lists that no longer have a clear purpose.
- ☐ Honour opt-out / erasure requests promptly and keep a do-not-contact list.